Ahmadnagar that the Padshah expected allegiance from but also the sultanates of Bijapur and Golconda, while Khandesh was already practically a Mughal dominion. As Bijapur and Golconda watched the Mughal behemoth roll towards them they looked to Safavid Perisa for assistance. From the early sixteenth century, Bijapur and Golconda had intermittently recognized a form of ‘ritual suzerainty’ towards the Safavids, inserting the names of their rulers in the Friday prayers. The huge influx of Iranian migrants to the Deccan in the last half of the sixteenth century had further contributed to a dynamic in which the Shia Safavids were expected to counterbalance the increasingly dangerous Sunni Mughals.

Hearing reports from Abu’l Fazl of the thoroughly impoverished state of the army in the Deccan, Akbar first dispatched orders for the Subedar of Gujarat to transfer to the Deccan all the surplus monies from the Gujarat treasury and Akbar sent 300,000 rupees from Agra too. Then, accompanied by some of the women of the harem, as well as the princes Khusrau and Khurram, Akbar left Agra for Malwa at the head of a huge army of about 80,000 to 100,000 horse, and 1,000 war elephants, in September 1599. In Malwa, the Mughal camp was joined by a sad cortège. Abu’l Fazl had organized for Murad’s body to be sent back along with his harem of women and children, his treasure, and his belongings. From Malwa, Murad’s body was sent to Delhi, where he joined the quiet company of his forefathers in the mausoleum of Humayun’s tomb.

It was then the turn of the Kachhwaha tribe to be hit by personal tragedy. Raja Man Singh’s oldest and favourite son, Kuar Jagat Singh, died suddenly at the age of thirty-two while preparing to take over the governorship of his father in Bengal. The raja was ‘discomposed by grief for his son’, wrote Abu’l Fazl, and Akbar sent him a horse and a robe of honour. Man Singh had lost his son, Himmat Singh, in 1597 and now the loss of his heir apparent, the son of his chief wife, Rani Kanakwati, was an almost intolerable tragedy. Rani Kanakwati suggested they build a temple in memory of Jagat Singh and so the Jagat Shiromani Temple was built outside Amer, on the main road leading from the Delhi gate of the walls to the base of Amer Fort. Built high above street level, unlike other temples, this exquisite Vaishnavite temple, as pointed out by Catherine Asher, has a mandap of red sandstone, white marble and grey stone, heavily influenced by Akbari architecture. With a gorgeous flight of white marble stairs leading to a marble gateway, the temple is suffused with an ethereal light and an air